

NUTRIPATH CANADA

CDO ETHICS CASE STUDIES - STUDY GUIDE



WHERE TO FIND CDO ETHICS RESOURCES

- STEP 1:** Go to College of Dietitians of Ontario website (collegeofdietitians.org)
- STEP 2:** Navigate to: Practice Advisory Program → Professional Practice Resources
→ Professional Ethics
- STEP 3:** Download these key PDFs:

ESSENTIAL CDO ETHICS DOCUMENTS TO DOWNLOAD

Document 1: Ethics and Professionalism Webinar (2019)

- File name: Workshop-2019-Ethics-and-Professionalism-Webinar-Final.pdf
- Contains: Multiple practice scenarios with ethical dilemmas^[1]
- Key scenarios include:

Scenario 4: "I don't want to be referred!" (14-year-old client, rural family health team)^[1]
Additional billing, referral, and confidentiality cases^[1]

Document 2: Ethics and Professionalism: Adapting to Change (2020)

- File name: 2020-Ethics-and-Professionalism-Adapting-to-Change-Handouts.pdf
- Contains: Workshop scenarios and group discussion cases^[2]

Document 3: Conflict of Interest & RD Practice

- File name: Conflict-of-Interest-RD-Practice.pdf
- Contains: Framework for analyzing conflicts + case examples^[3]
- Example: RD referring clients to grocery store program where they have financial interest^[3]



Document 4: Crossing Boundaries: Ten Cases and Ten Misconceptions

- File name: Crossing-Boundaries-Ten-Cases-and-Ten-Misconceptions.pdf
- Contains: 10 discipline-informed boundary violation cases^[4]
- Covers: Sexual misconduct, dual relationships, concealing professional status^[4]

Document 5: What is Professional Judgement?

- File name: ProfessionalJudgment.pdf
- Contains: Definition, framework, and risk assessment guidance^[5]

Document 6: Document 6: Testimonials and Direct Solicitation of Clients

- File name: Testimonials-and-Direct-Solicitation-of-Clients.pdf
- Contains: Scenarios on ethical marketing and client solicitation^[6]

Document 7: Managing Competing Interests

- File name: Managing-Competing-Interests.pdf
- Contains: How to handle situations where personal and professional interests conflict^[7]

HOW TO ANALYZE EACH CASE SCENARIO

USE THIS TEMPLATE FOR EVERY ETHICS CASE YOU STUDY:

CASE TITLE: _____

SCENARIO SUMMARY:

KEY QUESTION TO ANSWER:

☐ Is there an ethical dilemma? If yes, what is it?

ETHICAL PRINCIPLES INVOLVED:

- ☐ **Autonomy (Client self-determination)**
- ☐ **Beneficence (Do good/act in client's best interest)**
- ☐ **Non-maleficence (Do no harm)**
- ☐ **Justice (Fairness, equity)**
- ☐ **Fidelity (Trust, loyalty, honesty)**
- ☐ **Veracity (Truthfulness)**



CODE OF ETHICS PRINCIPLES APPLIED:

- ☐ Principle 1: Treat others with respect
- ☐ Principle 2: Act in a manner that engenders trust
- ☐ Principle 3: Act in accordance with ethical principles
- ☐ Principle 4: Accept accountability
- ☐ Principle 5: Uphold reputation of profession
- ☐ Principle 6: Maintain professional boundaries

CONFLICT OF INTEREST TEST (if applicable):

1. Am I relying on my professional judgment?
2. Will this action compromise my objectivity?
3. Is anything competing with my duty to my client?

DORM PRINCIPLE (for managing conflicts):

- ☐ D - Disclose the conflict
- ☐ O - Obtain consent
- ☐ R - Refer when necessary
- ☐ M - Maintain boundaries

MY DECISION/ACTION:

RATIONALE (Evidence-based):

ETHICS FRAMEWORKS TO MEMORIZE

CONFLICT OF INTEREST FRAMEWORK (from CDO)

1. Am I relying on my professional judgment?^[3]
2. Will this action compromise my objectivity?^[3]
3. Is anything competing with my duty to act in the best interests of my client?^[3]
4. Is the competing consideration so significant, or is my client so vulnerable, that a reasonable person would say I am at risk of acting unethically?^[3]



PROFESSIONAL JUDGMENT BUILDING BLOCKS (4 components)



1. Knowledge^[5]
2. Professional Obligations^[5]
3. Client Input^[5]
4. Experience (practical wisdom + reflective practice)^[5]

PROFESSIONAL JUDGMENT DEFINITION:

"Applying knowledge, skills and experience, in a way that is informed by professional standards, laws and ethical principles, to develop an opinion or decision about what should be done to best serve clients."^[5]

KEY ETHICS QUESTIONS FOR KCAT PREP

When reading any case, ask yourself:

1. Is there an ethical dilemma?^[1]
2. What ethical principle(s) relate to this dilemma?^[1]
3. How might you handle this situation?^[1]
4. Could this create a conflict of interest?^[3]
5. Does this involve a boundary crossing or violation?^[4]
6. Am I putting the client's interests first?^[5]
7. Can I provide evidence-based rationale for my decision?^[5]

STUDY CHECKLIST

- ☐ Downloaded all 7 CDO ethics PDFs listed above
- ☐ Read "What is Professional Judgment?" document
- ☐ Worked through "Conflict of Interest" framework and cases
- ☐ Reviewed all 10 cases in "Crossing Boundaries"
- ☐ Practiced analyzing scenarios using the template above
- ☐ Memorized the 4 Professional Judgment Building Blocks
- ☐ Memorized DORM Principle
- ☐ Completed OSAT self-assessment on Professionalism & Ethics section



References

- 1.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/Workshop-2019-Ethics-and-Professionalism-Webinar-Final.pdf>
- 2.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/2020-Ethics-and-Professionalism-Adapting-to-Change-Handouts-2-per-page.pdf>
- 3.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/Conflict-of-Interest-RD-Practice.pdf>
- 4.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/Crossing-Boundaries-Ten-Cases-and-Ten-Misconceptions.pdf>
- 5.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/ProfessionalJudgment.pdf>
- 6.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/Testimonials-and-Direct-Solicitation-of-Clients.pdf>
- 7.<https://collegeofdietitians.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/Managing-Competing-Interests.pdf>